

Lowndes Teacher Discovered Dead

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

A local primary school teacher was shot to death outside of the school where she was employed late Sunday night or early Monday morning, a Lowndes County sheriff's department official said.

Beverly K. Schappaugh, 48, of Lowndes County was found dead from a single bullet wound to the left side of her chest, said Capt. Billy Selph of the Lowndes County Sheriff's Department detective bureau.

She was found in a gray 1987 Nissan Sentra by a man walking his

dog around 6:45 a.m. Monday, Selph said. The car was parked on the east corner of a field by the Pine Grove Primary School where Ms. Schappaugh was employed as a teacher for several years, he said.

A handgun, which appeared to be a .38 caliber pistol, was lying beside her in the passenger seat, Selph said.

The sheriff's department report ruled the incident as a shooting death but Selph said Monday afternoon no final ruling has been made on the case.

"We don't know what we've got yet," he told *The Valdosta Daily*

Times. "This may be a homicide. We'll have to wait for a complete autopsy report before making a classification."

Ms. Schappaugh's body was sent to the state crime lab in Moultrie and is scheduled to be sent to Atlanta today for an autopsy.

Walter Wacter, Lowndes County coroner, told *The Times* his preliminary autopsy showed the victim died sometime between 5 p.m. Sunday to early Monday morning.

As for why Ms. Schappaugh was at the school, Selph said it is not uncommon for teachers to work on a Sunday.



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